

WEEKLY MARKETS SUMMARY

Week of August 3–7, 2026

Global Markets Analysis · Nomad Capital · August 2026

NASDAQ 100 —
WEEKLY CHG.**+5.09%**

28,307.30 → 29,748.14 pts

GOLD (SPOT) —
WEEKLY CHG.**+7.68%**

\$4,086.21 → \$4,400.00

WTI CRUDE OIL —
WEEKLY CHG.**−8.98%**

\$84.77 → \$77.16

ARGENTINA EMBI —
WEEKLY CHG.**+16 bps**

Close 8/6*: 446 bps

A week of sharp contrast between global and local sentiment —and where much of the global rally was driven more by narrative than by actual facts: Trump and Treasury Secretary Bessent repeated throughout the week that a deal with Iran to reopen the Strait of Hormuz would come “today or tomorrow,” sinking oil and pushing stocks higher each time they spoke —but Iran denied at every turn that it was negotiating directly with the U.S. (only with Oman), and no deal had been struck by Friday—. On top of that came a rebound in “big tech” after late July’s panic and a surprisingly weak U.S. jobs report that cooled rate-hike expectations: Wall Street posted a second straight week of gains, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq hitting fresh records. Meanwhile, the joint U.S.-Japan intervention to prop up the yen began losing steam, and UWM —the largest wholesale mortgage originator in the U.S.— rattled the mortgage market with a sharp plunge. In Argentina, by contrast, the week was negative: the Merval fell ~6% and country risk climbed all week, despite the favorable global backdrop.

1. Timeline of the Week

WEEKLY TIMELINE

Mon 8/3	Relief on reported Iran-U.S. de-escalation (Trump/Bessent talk up an imminent deal): stocks rise, yields fall, oil drops (WTI -5.55%). Argentina's EMBI compresses to 411 bps (-19 bps).
Tue 8/4	Positive tone continues: stocks and yields rise together, DXY firmer. The Central Bank tops \$49B in reserves; YPF gains liquidity after the split. EMBI rebounds to 421 bps (+10 bps).
Wed 8/5	Global markets rally (Nikkei +3.66%), gold starts a strong rise (+1.49%). INDEC reports poverty rises to 30% in Q1. EMBI at 428 bps (+7 bps).
Thu 8/6	Markets await the NFP report. Argentina renews its swap with China (\$19B, 5 years). Central Bank reserves top \$50B for the first time. EMBI at 446 bps (+18 bps); GD30D falls 4.08%.
Fri 8/7	NFP surprises with -23K jobs (vs. +80K expected): Wall Street reads it as a sign the Fed won't hike, sparking a rally to fresh records. In Argentina, the wholesale dollar nears \$1,500, country risk approaches the 450-460 zone, and the Central Bank buys just \$41M. An IMF payment (\$852M) pulls reserves down to \$48.835B.

2. Weekly Asset Price Changes

Prior close: Friday 7/31. Reference close: Friday 8/7.

Asset	Close Fri 7/31	Close Fri 8/7	Weekly chg.
S&P 500	7,489.80	7,757.64	+3.58%
Nasdaq 100	28,307.30	29,748.14	+5.09%
Dow Jones	52,485.74	54,036.93	+2.96%
VIX	15.99	14.90	-6.82%
10-Yr UST	4.74%	-4.65%	-9 bps
WTI (spot)	\$84.77	\$77.16	-8.98%
Gold (spot)	\$4,086.21	\$4,400.00	+7.68%
Bitcoin	\$62,964.22	\$64,928.32	+3.12%
EMBI Global (Argentina)	430 bps	446 bps*	+16 bps

Argentina local market	Close Fri 7/31	Close Fri 8/7	Weekly chg.
GD30D	\$0.5810	\$0.58	-0.17%
GD35D	\$0.8259	\$0.8143	-1.40%
S&P Merval (ARS)	3,291,322.63	3,086,784.54	-6.21%
S&P Merval (USD MEP)	2,166.44	2,031.73	-6.22%
USD MEP (AL30)	\$1,519.26	\$1,519.29	+0.81%

* Argentina's EMBI reflects the last confirmed official close (Thursday 8/6); JP Morgan publishes with a lag. The 10-Yr UST figure is an approximation from market sources (CNBC/AP), not an exact verified close.

3. Key Drivers of the Week

KEY DRIVERS

July NFP: a sharp negative surprise, but markets celebrate it	Payrolls fell -23K vs. +80K expected. Unemployment dropped to 4.1% (from 4.2%) due to falling labor force participation (61.4%, a 5-year low), not real job gains: U-6 held steady at 7.9%. Treasury yields fell (UST10 -9bps) and markets ruled out a September hike, fueling a record rally in stocks.
Big tech: from panic to euphoria	Late July's correction (Alphabet -15%, Meta -10% on AI capex fears, ~\$797B lost in a day by the Mag 7) reversed: Palantir +30%, Intel +11%, confirming the market rewards real monetization and punishes capex promises without evidence. The Nasdaq Composite added +5.2% for the week, its best week since April.
Yen: the joint U.S.-Japan intervention starts losing steam	After the first joint U.S.-Japan intervention since 2011 (7/31, Treasury selling euros to buy yen), the currency jumped to 155.20. Without an actual BOJ rate hike backing it, the rally has given back much of its gain: the yen trades near 158/dollar. Bessent called for the BOJ to hike as a necessary complement.
The U.S. mortgage market is rattled: UWM plunges	United Wholesale Mortgage, the largest wholesale mortgage originator in the country, plunged 35-49% on Thursday after a \$452M Q2 net loss and suspending its dividend for the first time since 2021. It received a \$2.05B capital injection (Oaktree + CEO's family). The stock is down ~83% from its 52-week high.
The Central Bank reform stays at the center of the debate	With the reform already announced, debate shifted to institutional sustainability—the 2010 Redrado precedent is cited as a warning—. Country risk kept climbing all week despite the favorable global backdrop, decoupling Argentine assets from the broader mood.
Iran: markets are trading on narrative, not facts	Bessent repeatedly said during the week (Tuesday, Wednesday) that a deal with Iran to reopen the Strait of Hormuz would come "today or tomorrow," and Trump reinforced the message, claiming "a lot of progress" had been made. Each statement sank oil and pushed stocks higher. But Iran denied at every turn that it was negotiating directly with the U.S.—only with Oman, on a separate and more limited arrangement—, and by Friday nothing had been finalized. The pattern has repeated multiple times since the conflict began.

4. Signals to Watch — Week of August 10–14

SIGNALS TO WATCH

Potential new FX intervention in Japan	With the yen giving back its post-intervention gain, Japan has signaled it will repeat the operation. Key: whether the BOJ backs it with more concrete rate-hike signals.
Legislative reaction to the Central Bank reform	The market will start pricing in the odds of Congressional approval, against rising country risk and the FX gap at its highs.
U.S. inflation data (July CPI)	With the Fed ruling out a September hike after the weak NFP, CPI will be key to confirming whether the labor slowdown comes with contained inflation.
Contagion from the UWM crisis to the mortgage sector	The market will watch closely whether UWM's plunge is isolated or the first sign of broader stress in wholesale mortgage financing.

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